



Business Result

Intermediate Student's Book

John Hughes & Jon Naunton



OXFORD

Business Result

Intermediate | Student's Book

John Hughes & Jon Naunton

Interactive Workbook material
by Alastair Lane & Chris Speck

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		Working with words	Business communication skills	Practically speaking	Language at work	Case study / Activity	Outcomes – you can:
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Introduction

Welcome to *Business Result Intermediate*. In this book you'll find:
| 16 units | Practice files | Information files | Audio scripts |
| Interactive Workbook on DVD-ROM |

We hope you find this introduction useful, and that you enjoy using the course.

What's in a unit?

Starting point

- an introduction to the unit topic
- discussion questions

Working with words

- includes reading and listening based on themes from business and the world of work
- teaches important new words and phrases that you can use immediately in your work
- practises the new vocabulary in a realistic final activity

Business communication skills

- presents key expressions for exchanging information, attending meetings, presenting information, and socializing
- helps you express yourself more clearly in real work situations
- lets you choose which phrases to use from the *Key expressions* list in every unit

Practically speaking

- teaches really useful everyday phrases for small talk, telephoning and short conversations
- helps you sound more natural when you speak English

Language at work

- reviews key grammar from *Business communication skills*
- helps you communicate more accurately in real work situations
- lets you check your knowledge of grammar and practise it in the classroom
- if you need more explanation, refer to the language reference section in the *Practice file*

Case study / Activity

- each unit ends with an authentic case study or activity
- find out about situations related to the unit topic that affect real companies and organizations
- take part in a longer work-related activity with lots of opportunities to practise the language from the unit

Fast-track option

If time on your course is limited, *Business Result* has a unique fast-track option to use in class. For each unit, combine the *Business communication skills* section and the *Case study or Activity*. This creates a practical, highly communicative shorter course, enabling you to get the maximum benefit from your Business English studies – fast.

What's in the Practice file?

The *Practice file* is like a mini-workbook in the back of the *Student's Book*. It allows you to think about and practise important words, expressions, and grammar. It has written exercises on the key language from each unit, plus a language reference section with more detailed grammar explanations.

Use the *Practice file*

- in class to check your understanding
- after class for extra practice.

Follow the links to the *Practice file* in each unit.

»» For more information and exercises, go to **Practice file 3** on page 106.

What's the Interactive Workbook on DVD-ROM?

The *Interactive Workbook* gives you practical tools to use immediately in your work by helping you to practise the language and skills from the *Student's Book*, and make them personal to you and your own work situation. It also helps you review and test your own progress.

Exercises and Tests

- review and practise key language with interactive exercises
- check your progress with unit tests

Glossary

- check the meaning of around 600 words and phrases
- personalize the vocabulary to your needs

Phrasebank

- listen to all the key expressions from the *Student's Book*
- learn phrases for exchanging information, meetings, presenting, socializing, telephoning, and travel
- create your own personal phrasebook

Email

- learn useful phrases for writing the most common work-related emails
- copy model emails to your out-box, or create your own

Listen again

- listen again to the *Student's Book* audio recordings, or download to your MP3 player

Video

- Watch a video clip related to a section in the unit. Every unit has a video clip which recycles and extends the language of the unit.
- Complete the interactive exercises while you watch the video clips
- This icon **VIDEO** shows you the section of the unit that the video relates to. Watch the video after you have completed the work in the *Student's Book*.

When you see this link, you can go to the *Interactive Workbook* for more practice.

 » Interactive Workbook »

Case studies with the Expert View from Cranfield School of Management

Each of the case studies in *Business Result Intermediate* is accompanied by an Expert View from Cranfield School of Management, one of Europe's leading management schools. It is part of Cranfield University, renowned for its high quality postgraduate teaching and research and its strong links to industry and business. The School of Management was

established in 1967, and offers a range of MBA, Executive MBA, Executive Education, and Doctoral programmes.

For more information, visit: www.som.cranfield.ac.uk/som.

Your panel of experts is made up of faculty from Cranfield, plus successful businesspeople who are recent MBA graduates from Cranfield.

Cranfield
UNIVERSITY
School of Management



1 Dr Martin Clarke, Programme Director, General Management Programme Group (see page 11)



2 Chris van der Hoven, Lecturer in Innovation (see page 17)



3 Cora Lynn Heimer-Rathbone, Programme Director, Centre for Customized Executive Development (see page 29)



4 Lynette Ryals, Professor of Strategic Sales and Account Management (see page 35)



5 Dr Michael Dickmann, Senior Lecturer, Director MSc International HRM (see page 41)



6 Eyal Ben Cohen, Managing Director, Verifile Limited, MBA alumnus (see page 47)



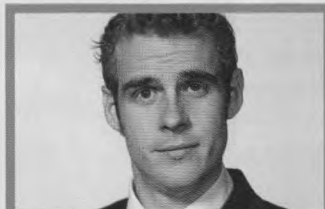
7 Raj Mulvadi, Full-time MBA graduate (see pages 53 and 95)



8 Manish Singh, Full-time MBA graduate (see pages 53 and 95)



9 Simone Taylor, Full-time MBA graduate (see pages 53 and 95)



10 David York, Full-time MBA graduate (see pages 53 and 95)



11 Richard Wilding, Professor of Supply Chain Risk Management (see page 59)



12 Simon Knox, Professor of Brand Marketing (see page 65)



13 Keith Goffin, Professor of Innovation and New Product Development (see page 77)



14 Dr Bob Lillis, Lecturer in Service Operations Management (see page 83)



15 Graham Clark, Senior Lecturer in Operations Management (see page 89)



16 David Molian, Bettany Centre for Entrepreneurial Performance & Economics (see page 101)

1

Working life

Learning objectives in this unit

- Talking about your work and responsibilities
- Introducing yourself and others
- Expressing interest in conversations
- Using the present simple and frequency adverbs to talk about your job and routine activities

Case study

- Speed networking

Starting point

1 Which things in this list are the most / least important for you in a job?

- money
- job satisfaction and professional development
- free time
- recognition
- job security
- career opportunities and opportunities for promotion
- variety
- training

2 When you were a child, what job did you dream about doing? Why?

Working with words | Describing work

- 1 Ed Lu is an astronaut who spent six months on the International Space Station. Read what he says about working there. List the positive and negative points of his job.

A job among the stars

Working on the ISS (International Space Station) is every astronaut's dream. Life on board may sound glamorous to some people, but conditions can be uncomfortable and we have a demanding schedule – we work ten-hour days and have one and a half days off – although when you live in your office, it's hard to separate on-duty and off-duty.

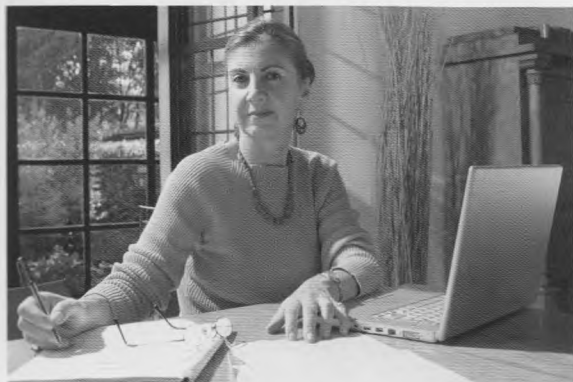
Our tasks are quite varied – we do a range of different scientific experiments – but we also have to perform routine maintenance and regular safety checks, like cleaning the air filter and inspecting our emergency equipment. We exercise twice a day – if you don't, your muscles just disappear in the weightless conditions.

Life is never dull, but you can feel lonely up here, away from friends and family. The work can also be stressful, so in my free time I relax by writing and answering emails. I also love taking photos of the views from up here. It's fun to watch stars as they rise through the atmosphere.



2 01, 02▷ When Ingrid was a child she wanted to become a doctor. Mansour's ambition was to be a pilot. Listen and find out

- 1 what they do now
- 2 what they like / dislike about their work.



3 How near are they to their childhood dreams?

4 Work with a partner. Match the words from the list to definitions 1–11.

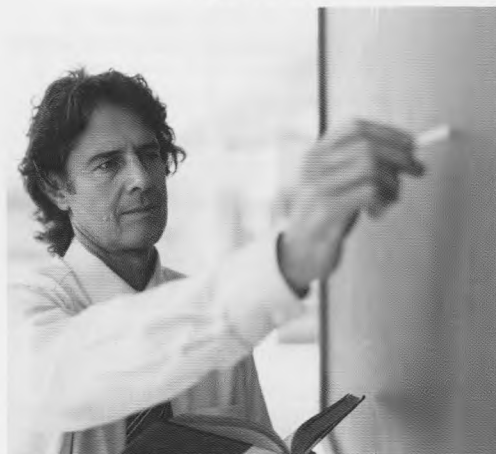
fun varied challenging routine depressing stressful
glamorous worthwhile rewarding dull demanding

- 1 a good thing to do: _____
- 2 boring: _____
- 3 needing all our effort and attention: _____
- 4 difficult in a satisfying way: _____
- 5 lively and enjoyable: _____
- 6 looks attractive from the outside: _____
- 7 predictable, the same every day: _____
- 8 makes us feel unhappy: _____
- 9 different, not always the same: _____
- 10 makes us feel worried or anxious: _____
- 11 makes us feel good: _____

» For more exercises, go to Practice file 1 on page 102.

5 Work with a partner. Describe these jobs using words from 4.

Example: Being a teacher is quite a challenging job because you have to teach large groups of people who have different abilities. It's also very rewarding.



6 Work with a partner or in small groups. Describe your own job using words from 4.

② » Interactive Workbook » Glossary

Socializing | Introductions and saying what you do



- 1 An NGO is a non-governmental organization. Amnesty International and the Fairtrade Foundation are two well-known NGOs. Can you think of any others?
- 2 03▷ The Culham Health Trust is an NGO based in New York. It has invited its key personnel, sponsors, and fundraisers to its headquarters to mark its 20th anniversary. Listen to these two conversations. Which is more formal? How do you know?
- 3 03▷ Listen again and write notes in this table.

	Job and responsibilities
Luc Akele	
Jo Johansson	
Walter Mayer	

- 4 Put phrases a–h below into categories 1–3. Then decide which are more formal and which are less formal.
 - 1 Introducing yourself: _____
 - 2 Introducing someone else: _____
 - 3 Responding to an introduction: _____
 - a I want you to meet ...
 - b This is ...
 - c I'm delighted to meet you.
 - d I'm very pleased to meet you too.
 - e I don't think we've met. I'm ...
 - f Nice to meet you.
 - g I would / I'd like to introduce you to ...
 - h My name's ...

- 5 04▷ Listen and complete these sentences.

- 1 Well, I _____ fund applications.
- 2 Well, I'm _____ our sub-Saharan Africa operations.
- 3 I _____ projects and make sure that the money is well spent.
- 4 I'm _____ their medical donations programme.
- 5 I _____ all the inter-governmental work.
- 6 It _____ a lot of negotiation.

» For more exercises, go to **Practice file 1** on page 102.

Tip | *actually*

Use *actually* to mean *in fact*, not *at the moment*, or *right now*. It's a polite way to correct or contradict someone.

A Which part of the States are you from?

B *Actually*, I'm from Ontario, in Canada.

- 6 Work with a partner. Choose a job from A, but don't tell your partner which one. Describe the job's responsibilities using words from B and phrases from 5. Your partner must guess the job.

Example: A *This person deals with customers and is responsible for responding to complaints.*
B *Is he / she an after-sales assistant?*

A sales rep marketing director administrator website designer finance controller lab technician human resources manager team leader after-sales assistant	B budget customers personnel paperwork targets travel product development projects training recruitment publicity complaints money machinery
--	--

- 7 Work in groups of three. Each person chooses a job from 6.
- Student A, introduce yourself to Student B, and then introduce Student C to Student B. Find out about each other's jobs and responsibilities.
 - Change roles and use your own jobs and responsibilities. Work together and find out as much as you can about each other.

i » Interactive Workbook » Email

Key expressions

Introducing yourself

Hello. / Hi. I'm ...
Hello. / Hi. My name's ...
I don't think we've met. I'm ...

Introducing other people

This is ...
I want you to meet ...
I'd like to introduce you to ...

Exchanging greetings

Nice to meet you.
I'm very pleased to meet you.
I'm delighted to meet you.

Saying what you do

I deal with ...
I handle ...
I oversee ...
I'm in charge of (+ noun / -ing) ...
I'm responsible for (+ noun / -ing) ...
My job involves (+ noun / -ing) ...

i » Interactive Workbook
» Phrasebank

Practically speaking | How to express interest

- 1 Which of these phrases is *not* a direct response to something someone has just said?
- Really?
 - A recruitment consultant?
 - That sounds ...
 - So tell me, ...
 - Oh right.
- 2 Complete this conversation with phrases from 1 above.
- A I'm a recruitment consultant.
B ¹ _____
A Yes. I oversee recruitment for ten of our key accounts.
B ² _____ really demanding.
A It can be at times. ³ _____ what exactly does your job involve?
B Well, I'm responsible for the department's spending.
A ⁴ _____ Do you enjoy your job?
B I love it. It's great to be in a such a position of responsibility.
A ⁵ _____ I think I'd find it stressful.
- 3 05▷ Listen and compare your answers from 2 above.
- 4 Work with a partner. Tell each other some information about your job. Respond with phrases from 2 and try to continue the conversation.

Example: A *I work twelve hours a day.*
B *Twelve hours a day? What do you do?*

Tip | right and really

In the UK, *really* and *right* can mean the same thing. They can both show that you are interested in what someone is saying.

A *I do a lot of work in China.*

B *Right. / Really?*

In the US, *right* confirms that what someone has said is correct.

A *So, you work twelve hours a day?*

B *Right – four days a week.*

Language at work | Present simple review | Frequency adverbs

1 Read this conversation. Why are the verbs in **bold** in the present simple?

Hitoshi Dr Mayer, this is Véronique Denvir. She **works** for Medicine on the Move. It's a small medical NGO.

Dr Mayer Pleased to meet you, Ms Denvir. So, which countries does your organization deal with? Do you work in Nigeria?

Véronique No, we mainly **focus** on Angola. We regularly **visit** villages and set up temporary clinics.

Dr Mayer And who funds your projects?

Véronique Mostly the general public, but we also get some government grants.

Dr Mayer Oh, that's interesting. Can I ask who your medical supplier is?

2 Which of the questions a–d below from 1

- 1 can only be answered *yes* or *no*? _____
 - 2 require information in the answer? _____
 - 3 is / are indirect? _____
 - 4 doesn't / don't use an auxiliary verb? _____ Why is this?
- a So, which countries does your organization deal with?
 - b Do you work in Nigeria?
 - c And who funds your projects?
 - d Can I ask who your medical supplier is?

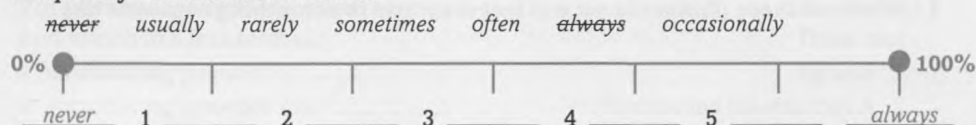
» For more information and exercises, go to Practice file 1 on page 103.

3 Work with a partner. Ask and answer questions about your jobs. Think about the hours you work, the distance from home, your tasks / responsibilities, and your colleagues / partners.

4 Now work with a different partner. Ask your new partner questions about his / her first partner. Start each question with *Do you know ...?*

Example: Do you know where Johann works?

5 Frequency adverbs say how often we do something. Complete this scale with frequency adverbs from the list.



» For more information and exercises, go to Practice file 1 on page 103.

6 Match adverbs from 5 to the phrases in *italics* in 1–5.

- 1 I work late *once in a while*, if I have a lot of work to finish. _____
- 2 My colleagues seem to be stressed *all the time*. _____
- 3 I *hardly ever* use the phone – I prefer to use email. _____
- 4 *From time to time* I go on a trip abroad if my boss can't go. _____
- 5 We *don't often* meet socially – maybe two or three times a year. _____

7 Work with a partner. Ask and answer questions about how often you do these things. Try to keep the conversation going as long as possible.

- travel for work
- work at the weekend
- have meetings with your boss
- eat lunch at your desk
- deal with clients
- socialize with your colleagues

Example: A How often do you travel for work?

B Once in a while. Every few months, I guess.

Speed networking

Background

Need more good contacts? Contact25 thinks it has the answer

Networking is increasingly important for individuals and companies who want to succeed in the world of international business. Contact25 organizes business-to-business speed networking events. At these events, participants have a series of mini-meetings with new contacts. The idea is that within a few minutes of talking to someone, they will know whether it is possible to do business with them. This makes it a very efficient form of business networking – by meeting lots of people, you have more chance of meeting ideal contacts for your business.

How does it work? Each meeting lasts

5 minutes. You have:

- 2 minutes to talk about your company / organization
- 2 minutes to talk about your partner's company / organization
- 30 seconds to score your partner, and note down future action
- 30 seconds to move on to the next meeting.

Speed networking is proving to be a good solution for many businesses who simply want to get results. Contact25 estimates that each attendee creates €5,000 worth of new business per event. So it seems that speed networking is simple, effective, and generates results.

The Expert View

Networking is important not only for generating business. In today's more complex and inter-related organizations, networking is also an essential management skill. Personal relationships are a source of information and power – the better the quality of your network, the more 'social capital' you have. Contacts outside your organization and industry give you an external perspective that enables innovation. A wide range of relationships inside your organization provides you with opportunities to build support and develop your ideas.

Dr Martin Clarke, Programme Director,
General Management Programme Group
Cranfield School of Management

Discussion

- 1 Why is networking important?
- 2 What are the advantages and disadvantages of speed networking?
- 3 Contact25 is thinking of going international. How could they make international speed networking possible?

Task

- 1 You are going to participate in a speed networking event. Be yourself or choose a profile from File 01 on page 135. Make a note of your name, what you do, the name of your company / organization, what it does, and your personal and professional reasons for attending the event.
- 2 Work in small groups. Follow the rules of speed networking. Try to make as many useful contacts as possible and make a good impression on the people you meet.
For each meeting
 - introduce yourself, say what you do, and who you represent
 - explain what the company / organization you represent does and why you are at this event
 - listen to your partner do the same as above and take notes
 - give your partner a score from 1 to 3 based on the following three statements
 - 'I would never want to work with this person.' = 1 point
 - 'I might want to work with them but I need to find out more about them.' = 2 points
 - 'I'm definitely interested in working with this person and will follow this up immediately.' = 3 points
 - note what you are going to do next with your contact.
- 3 Tell the group who your most useful contact was, and what follow-up action you will take.

Case study



2 Projects

Learning objectives in this unit

- Talking about projects
- Updating and delegating tasks in a meeting
- Starting and ending phone calls
- Talking about your work and current activities using the present simple and continuous

Case study

- Planning a launch party

Starting point

- 1 What makes a project successful?
- 2 Do you prefer to lead a project or just be part of the project team? Why?
- 3 Do you like being involved in long-term projects?



Working with words | Projects

1 Read this article and answer questions 1–4.

- 1 What is volunteerism?
- 2 What sorts of things can employee volunteers do?
- 3 Who benefits from volunteering and how?
- 4 What has Samira Khan learnt from her project?

A commitment to volunteerism

What does volunteerism mean?

The clothing manufacturer, Timberland, is one of many large companies that are committed to volunteerism. The company encourages staff to spend up to 40 paid hours a year on community and social projects. The community benefits from the company's **resources**, staff gain new skills and **teamwork** improves.

The French food manufacturer, Danone, allows its employees to spend time in developing countries, working on projects in areas like conservation, teaching, caring, or building. In doing so, they can share their own **skills**, and at the same time, they gain new ideas and insights, and learn from the experiences of others.

A team from the banking group, HBOS, volunteered to help build an extension to a school in La Esperanza in Honduras. Linda Marshall, the project leader, said, 'I learnt that when new teams are forming, it is essential that **objectives** are agreed and everyone buys into them. This is a crucial factor to any project's success.'

What can volunteering do for you?

Software engineer, Samira Khan, is in charge of a volunteer project to redecorate a community centre for the elderly in Chicago. Managing a project is a new experience for her. She is

learning how to organize a **schedule** so that they are able to complete the project before its **deadline**. She also has to deal with the **budget**, which is fairly limited, so she has to spend carefully. And every few days, she gets **updates** from her project team to check on progress and decide if they need more resources. She finds working on this project very rewarding and is pleased to be learning new skills.



2 Label these items with the words in bold from the text in 1.

1 _____

It was agreed that Jonas will

- look at ways of cutting spending
- talk to the bank about a loan
- aim to balance the books in 6 months.

2 _____

Sunhills community project

Completed: wiring and plumbing

Ongoing: plastering and tiling

Still to do: decorating and furnishing

3 _____

June

5 June: complete decorating

6 June: safety checks

10 June: official opening

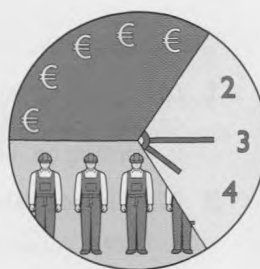
4 _____

Venue:	€2,000
Catering:	€4,000
Transport:	€350
Total:	€6,350

5 _____

- Accomplished in bookkeeping.
- Knows how to operate a variety of computer software.
- Speaks English and Spanish.

6 _____



7 _____



8 _____

3 06▷ Samira is telling someone about the volunteer project that she is working on. Listen to these extracts from the conversation and answer questions 1–2.

- 1 Which items in 2 does she talk about?
- 2 What does she say about each one?

4 06▷ Listen again and complete the phrases that Samira uses in column A. Then work with a partner. Take turns to cover column A while your partner tests you using the definitions in column B.

Example: A How can you say 'finish on time'?

B 'Meet the deadline'?

A Yes.

A

- 1 _____ the deadline
- 2 fall _____ schedule
- 3 catch _____
- 4 be back _____ track
- 5 finish _____ schedule
- 6 _____ resources
- 7 stay _____ budget
- 8 _____ tasks
- 9 get _____ a task
- 10 _____ updates

B

- = finish on time
- = make slow progress
- = get back to the original schedule
- = work to the predicted schedule
- = finish before the planned date
- = make use of people, money, time
- = spend the right amount of money
- = give people different responsibilities
- = do a job
- = receive reports on progress

5 Work in small groups. A colleague has been asked to take over running a project for someone who is off sick. He / she has never managed a project alone. He / she has asked you for advice about how to manage the project and the project team. Discuss what advice you will give him / her. Then tell the class.

Example: He / she needs a realistic schedule to meet the deadline.

» For more exercises, go to Practice file 2 on page 104.

» Interactive Workbook » Glossary

Tip | in time and on time

In time means having enough time to be able to do something.

*If we leave now, we'll be there **in time** for the meeting.*

On time means at the correct time.

*I have to be at work at 9 a.m. and I always arrive **on time**. I'm never late, but I don't like to be early either.*

Meetings | Updating and delegating tasks



TO DO:

Call Samira Khan (community centre)

Check re:

- deadline - can they meet it?

- decorating?

- lighting?

- carpets?

- action?

1 07▷ Jamie Ortega oversees several volunteer projects in the Chicago area. He is calling Samira Khan to ask about the progress of the community centre project she is working on. Listen to their conversation and makes notes on Jamie's notepad.

2 07▷ Listen again and complete these phrases.

- 1 How _____ over there?
- 2 Well, so far _____.
- 3 Everything's _____.
- 4 So what's _____ the decorating?
- 5 We're _____ the ceiling ...
- 6 And where _____ the lighting?
- 7 We've _____ ...
- 8 So, _____, the painting's nearly done, ...
- 9 So it's all going according _____.

3 Put the phrases from 2 into these categories.

- a Asking for an update: _____
- b Giving an update: _____
- c Summarizing: _____

4 Work with a partner. Look at this schedule for an office move. Ask and answer questions about the project using phrases from 2.

Example: A What's happening with the headed stationery?

B We've ordered it.

Office move progress update 11/05

Task	Deadline	Date finished
Order headed stationery	10/05	09/05
Order new furniture	10/05	10/05
Send new address cards to clients	11/05	To do
Issue staff with new badges	11/05	10/05
Pack up paperwork	15/05	ongoing

5 08▷ Listen to this meeting between Samira, Jamie, and team members, Josie and Bruno. Who agrees to

- 1 meet the carpet suppliers? _____
- 2 buy the paint? _____
- 3 paint the ceiling? _____

Tip | Dates

Dates are written differently in the US and the UK. In British English the day comes before the month. In American English the month comes before the day.

the tenth of May = 10/05 (British English); 05/10 (American English)

- 6 08▷ Listen again. Mark 1–10: *A* (allocating a task), *O* (offering / agreeing to do a task), *D* (declining to do a task), or *S* (summarizing).

- 1 We need somebody to be here then to open up. _____
- 2 Can you do it? _____
- 3 Leave it with me. _____
- 4 I can go there this afternoon if you want. _____
- 5 Why don't I go there now? _____
- 6 I'd prefer not to if that's OK. _____
- 7 I'll come with you, then. _____
- 8 You can carry on with the rest of this paint. _____
- 9 I'm sorry, I have an appointment. _____
- 10 So, you two are going to get the paint ... _____

» For more exercises, go to Practice file 2 on page 104.

- 7 Work with a partner. Some students are visiting your company and you need to: book a room for the talk (task 1), get name badges (task 2), organize refreshments (task 3). Have a conversation using this flow chart.

A Ask B to do task 1.

B Agree, and ask A to do task 2.

A Decline and give a reason.

B Offer to do task 2.

A Offer to do task 3.

B Recap.

- 8 Work with a partner. Two project update meetings took place yesterday. Student A, turn to File 03 on page 136. Student B, use the information below.

Student B: You went to the Project 2 meeting. Your partner went to the Project 1 meeting. Your partner will call you. Tell him / her about Project 2, then find out what is happening with Project 1. These are the things you need to know.

Project 1 - organizing a training day for staff

- Vene for training session?
- Hotel for trainers?
- Lunch?
- Information pack for trainees?
- Other?

Project 2 - raising money for a local children's charity

- Posters and leaflets - printing now
- 10 km sponsored run - need to contact council about using municipal ground
- Charity sale - all staff have received a memo
- Need someone to organize collection boxes

» Interactive Workbook » Email

Key expressions

Asking for an update

How are things going?
What's happening with ...?
Where are we with ...?

Giving an update

So far so good.
Everything's on track.
We're (+ -ing) ...
We've finished / completed ..., etc.

Allocating a task

Can you ...?
You can ...
I / We need somebody / you to ...

Offering to do something

Why don't I ...?
I'll ...
I can ... if you want.
Leave it with me.

Declining to do something

I'm sorry, I can't.
I'm afraid I'm busy.
I'd prefer not to (if that's OK).

Summarizing

So, to recap ...
X is / am / are going to ...
It's all going according to plan.

» Interactive Workbook
» Phrasebank

Practically speaking | How to start and end phone calls

- 1 Complete phrases a–f below. Which ones can you use to

- 1 start a call? _____
- 2 end a call? _____
- a I'm returning your ____.
- c ____'s (name) here.
- e What can I ____ for you?
- b Thanks ____ your help.
- d ____ for calling.
- f I'm ____ about / for / to ...

- 2 Work with a partner. Have three phone calls using phrases from 1.

- You want to know the time of a meeting tomorrow.
- You want an expenses authorization form.
- You are calling someone back with information about your holiday dates.

Language at work | Present simple and continuous

1 Look at the verbs in bold in these two sentences. Which tenses are used and why?

- 1 I'm **calling** for an update.
- 2 I **get** updates from people every two days.

2 Read these two questions. Are they talking about now or in general? Why do they use different tenses?

- 1 What's happening with the decorating?
- 2 What else do we need to do at the moment?

3 Complete these rules with *simple* or *continuous*.

- 1 Use the present _____ to talk about general facts or regular actions.
- 2 Use the present _____ to talk about a current action or temporary project.
- 3 Some verbs are not used in the present _____ when they are talking about states, not actions. For example: *understand, like, know, believe, mean, need*.

4 Choose the correct answer from the words in *italics*.

- 1 What *is he doing* / *does he do* in my office?
- 2 He *fixes* / *is fixing* your computer.
- 3 He *is knowing* / *knows* what is wrong with it now.
- 4 He *repairs* / *is repairing* computers every day – that's his job.

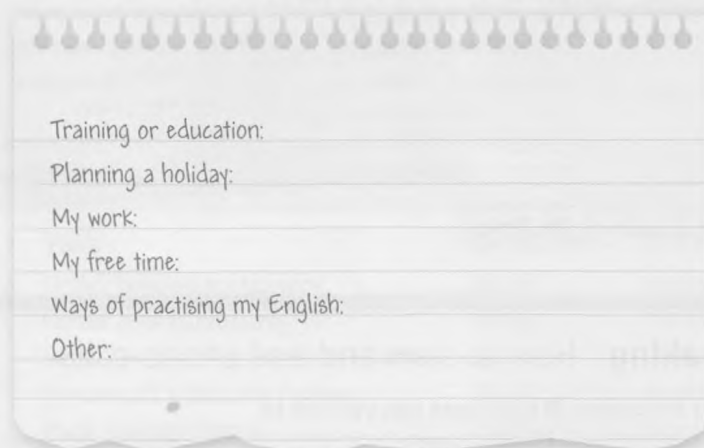
»» For more information and exercises, go to **Practice file 2** on page 105.

5 Work with a partner. Ask and answer questions using these prompts.

- 1 what / you / work on / this week?
- 2 you / like / travelling?
- 3 how often / you / work late?
- 4 you / have / any problems at work / at the moment?
- 5 who / you / talk to / right now?
- 6 how many people / be / in your English class today?
- 7 what / you / think / at the moment?
- 8 you / understand / the word 'deadline'?

6 Write notes on the notepad below about some current events or activities in your life.

- 1 Give a mini presentation to the class using your notes.
- 2 Listen to other members of the class and prepare two questions on their presentations.



Training or education:

Planning a holiday:

My work:

My free time:

Ways of practising my English:

Other:

Planning a launch party

Background

The sustainable dance club

Enviu is an international organization which helps young people develop profitable business ideas that have a positive effect on the environment and the local community.

Enviu is working in partnership with the architectural firm Döll on an exciting new project – a sustainable dance club in the city of Rotterdam.

The club will have a low impact on the environment, recycle energy, and raise

awareness among young people of social and environmental issues.

Enviu and Döll are cooperating with the Technical University of Delft and the Development Board of Rotterdam. Around 80 volunteers, mostly students and young professionals, are working on the project. They're helping to construct and equip the club ready for the launch party in a few weeks' time.

Discussion

- 1 In what ways are nightclubs environmentally unfriendly?
- 2 How could you make one more environmentally friendly?
- 3 09▷ Listen to one of the volunteers talking about the project. Compare what she says with your answers to 1 and 2 above.

Task

- 1 You are part of the project team planning to open a sustainable club in your city or town. The project is nearly complete and you are now planning the launch party which will take place in one month. Read about the key tasks that need to be done in this table.

The venue	The launch party	Publicity
Finalize installation of electrical equipment	Confirm all DJs and special events	Print leaflets and posters
Finish the decoration	Confirm orders with food and drink suppliers	Start distributing leaflets and posters, send out invitations
Equip the relaxation zone	Receive delivery from food and drink suppliers	Update the website
Install kitchens and toilets	Hire and train staff	Organize a radio advertisement

- 2 The project team has divided into groups, A, B, and C. Each group has different responsibilities. Read the information for your group. Group A, turn to File 04 on page 136. Group B, turn to File 11 on page 138. Group C, turn to File 20 on page 140.

- 3 When you have read your information, hold a meeting to discuss the key tasks. Make sure you know at the end of the meeting exactly what needs to be done, who will do it, and when.

- Update the other members of the project team.
- Make a note of the tasks that are complete and of all the tasks that still have to be done.
- Discuss as a team how you will proceed.
- Allocate tasks and create a schedule for completing them.

The Expert View

The project planning process should ensure that the work (scope) can be done within the deadlines (time) and budget (cost), and to the right specification (quality). These four elements (variables) are inter-related, and together make up the project baseline. If one of them changes – for example a reduction in time or budget, or an increase in scope – then the others need to be adjusted to keep the baseline business benefit. A good project manager is able to judge what the trade-off is if one of the variables changes. This requires clear thinking during planning, and careful tracking during the execution of the project.

Chris van der Hoven, Lecturer in Innovation
Cranfield School of Management

Case study

3 Leisure time

Learning objectives in this unit

- Talking about your work-life balance
- Talking about your likes and dislikes
- Exchanging contact details
- Ending a conversation
- Using the past simple and present perfect to talk about past experiences

Activity

- Corridor conversations

Starting point

- 1 What is 'work-life balance'?
- 2 Why should employers care about work-life balance?
- 3 Is there a 'long-hours' working culture in your country?

Working with words | Work-life balance

1 Read this article and answer questions 1–3.

- 1 Do you work similar hours to Todd Einck in his old job or his new job?
- 2 What does Todd tell his employees? Do you think he is right?
- 3 Could you do the same at your workplace? Why / Why not?

No more late nights

After working fifteen-hour days for most of his career, Todd Einck, 42, left his sales job and started JLT Mobile Computers. He wanted to create an organization where he could control his schedule and have time for his wife and young children. Nowadays, Todd leaves work by 5.10 p.m. almost every evening and he tells his fifteen employees to do the same. Working at the weekend or taking assignments home is also not allowed.



2 This is a quiz about your work-life balance.

- 1 Complete the quiz. Then add up your scores and turn to File 02 on page 135.
- 2 Do you agree with your results?

Find out your work-life balance

Write 2 if the statement is true for you, 1 if it's mostly true and 0 if it's not true.

- 1 I have plenty of time for outside interests and hobbies.
- 2 I occasionally do overtime if it is paid.
- 3 I work flexitime or am able to organize my work and home life around each other.
- 4 I leave my 'to do' list on my desk and rarely work from home.
- 5 I regularly relax by doing exercise or socializing with friends.
- 6 I regularly play sports in order to make useful work contacts.
- 7 I take all my paid leave every year and go on holiday.

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- 3 10▶ Work with a partner. Listen to this conversation between two colleagues, Nina and Florin. Student A, listen to Nina. Which parts of the quiz can you answer for her? Student B, listen to Florin. Which parts of the quiz can you answer for him? Now compare Nina and Florin's work-life balance. Who do you think has a better work-life balance?

- 4 Match these verbs from the quiz in 2 and audio 10▶ to the words in 1–4.

take make do work

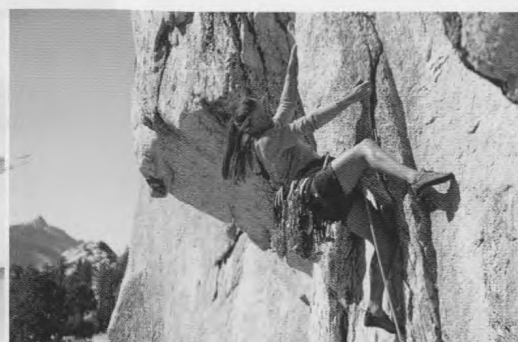
- 1 _____ exercise / work / overtime
- 2 _____ me somewhere / some holiday / paid leave / time off
- 3 _____ late / from home / flexitime
- 4 _____ time / useful contacts / progress

- 5 Work with a partner. Talk about the following using words from 4.

- a typical week (*Example: I regularly work from home ...*)
- this week or last week (*Example: I made a lot of progress last week ...*)
- your holidays this year (*Example: I'd like to take three weeks ...*)
- the company policy on overtime (*Example: We do three hours extra ...*)

- 6 Work with a partner. Use adjectives from the list to describe the activities in the pictures.

exciting boring relaxing exhilarating tiring
interesting frightening enjoyable hard work



- 7 Work with a partner. Take turns to describe what you do outside work and why.

Example: I cook a lot because it's relaxing and interesting to create new dishes.

- 8 11▶ A lot of adjectives in 6 can have an *-ing* ending or an *-ed* ending. Listen again. Which ending do you hear? Which form of the adjective describes how a person feels?

- 1 I got home at about midnight. I'm really *tired* / *tiring*.
- 2 I'm taking the kids camping tomorrow. They're so *excited* / *exciting*.
- 3 I made dinner and watched a *bored* / *boring* documentary about plants.

» For more exercises, go to Practice file 3 on page 106.

- 9 Work with a partner. Say what you are

- | | |
|-----------------|------------------|
| • interested in | • bored with |
| • tired of | • exhilarated by |
| • excited about | • frightened of. |

- 10 What's your ideal balance of work and leisure time? Think about the following. Then work with a partner. Take turns to describe the current situation in each area, how you might like to change things, and how this would make you feel.

- | | |
|----------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| • hours worked in the week | • activities outside work |
| • hours in the office | • number of weeks' holiday per year |
| • type of job | • types of holiday |

Tip | really and so

Use *really* or *so* to add emphasis.

I'm really excited.

I'm so tired.

I really like cycling.

It's so exhilarating.

Note that when you use *really* with the negative form you can say either of the following

1 *I really don't like cycling.*

2 *I don't really like cycling.*

The position of *really* in 1 adds greater emphasis. The speaker in 1 dislikes cycling more than the speaker in 2.

Exchanging information | Talking about leisure | Exchanging contact details



- 1 12▷ Mirella Lyrio from Brazil is on a three-month work placement at a Swedish company. It is the end of her first week and she meets her line manager, Leif Gunnarsson. Listen and complete her notes.

Department in week 1: _____

Department in week 2: _____

Travel to: _____

Weekend plans: _____

Need to buy: _____

- 2 12▷ Listen again and complete these questions. Can you remember Mirella's answers to Leif's questions? Listen again and check if necessary.

- 1 _____ working in (HR)?
- 2 _____ your first time in (Europe)?
- 3 _____ things do you like doing?
- 4 _____ the accommodation?
- 5 _____ the family?

- 3 Work with a partner. You are both working abroad on a six-month work placement / contract. Decide what country and department you are in. Then take turns to ask and answer the questions in 2. Change the information in brackets.

- 4 12▷ Match the phrases from the list to the words in *italics* in 1–4. Then listen again and check your answers.

isn't keen on *isn't crazy about* *'s interested in* *'s fond of*

- 1 She *wants to know more about* Human Resources. _____
- 2 He *really likes and cares about* Brazil. _____
- 3 She *is not enthusiastic or excited about* shopping. _____
- 4 She *doesn't really like* museums. _____

Tip | *like* + *-ing* or the infinitive

You can use the infinitive or the *-ing* form after the verb *like*. In British English *like* + *-ing* is normally used to talk about enjoyment and leisure activities. *Like* + the infinitive is used for choices and habits. In American English, *like* + the infinitive is normally used for both.

Do you *like reading* novels? / I *like to relax* at the weekend. (British English)

Do you *like to read* novels? (American English)

- 5 Work with a partner. Talk about things you like or dislike and about your interests using this table.

Example: I'm really interested in marketing.

I'm (not)	(really)	interested in fond of keen on crazy about	area of work, e.g. computers. city / country, e.g. Paris. subject, e.g. mathematics. activity, e.g. cooking. sport, e.g. golf. friends.
-----------	----------	--	--

- 6 13▷ Listen to the rest of Mirella's conversation with Leif and complete her notes. How does Mirella check her spelling?

Extension no.: _____
_____ for an outside line.
Company no.: _____
Email: _____

- 7 Write down two telephone numbers and two email addresses.

- 1 Tell your partner your email addresses and telephone numbers.
- 2 Listen to your partner's email addresses and telephone numbers and write them down.
- 3 Check you both got them right.

» For more exercises, go to Practice file 3 on page 106.

- 8 Work with a partner. Read the information for Student A and Student B below and plan what questions you might ask or what you might say about the following.

- accommodation
- work responsibilities
- free time and interests

Student A: You are on a placement at a new company. It is the end of your first week.

Student B: Your partner is on a placement at your company. Check that he / she is happy with everything.

Have the conversation and exchange contact details for the weekend.

① » Interactive Workbook » Email

Key expressions

Talking about leisure and interests

Do you like playing tennis / to relax in the evening?

Is this your office / favourite restaurant?

What sort of music do you like / things do you like doing?

How is your hotel / often do you play?

How do you find our country / your job?

Talking about likes and dislikes

I like / really like / love (+ -ing / to ... / noun)

I don't like / hate (+ -ing / to ... / noun)

I enjoy / don't enjoy (+ -ing)...

I'm (not) interested in / keen on / fond of / crazy about (+ -ing / noun)

Saying telephone numbers

00 = double zero / zero zero / double oh (British English)

Say telephone numbers in groups of three or four: 096 ... 745 ... 6745

Saying email addresses

/ (forward) slash

. dot

_ underscore

- dash

@ at

lower case / UPPER CASE

Checking spelling

S for sugar

E for egg

P for Paris, etc.

① » Interactive Workbook
» Phrasebank

Practically speaking | How to end a conversation

- 1 Which of these expressions signal the end of a conversation?

- 1 Anyway, I'd better get on.
- 2 I need to go now, I'm afraid.
- 3 I'll get back to him in a minute.
- 4 I should get back to work.

- 2 14▷ Listen to the ends of three conversations and check your answers in 1.

- 3 14▷ Listen again. How do the people respond to the phrases you chose in 1?

- 4 Work in small groups. Have conversations on the following subjects. End the conversations politely before starting the next one with a different person.

- what you did yesterday evening
- a problem you're having at work
- a phone call to check on the time of a meeting

Language at work | Past simple and present perfect

- 1 Work with a partner. Think of questions for these answers. Compare your ideas with the rest of the class.

‘Yes, I did. It was fascinating.’

‘Good, thanks.’

‘Yes, a couple of times.’

‘No, I haven’t.’

- 2 15▷ It is Monday morning. Mirella Lyrío is waiting for her manager, Leif, outside his office. Listen for the answers in 1. What were the questions?

- 3 15▷ Listen again. Decide if these sentences are true (T) or false (F). How do you know which sentences are false? Discuss your ideas with a partner.

- 1 Mirella waited for Leif and then left. ____
- 2 She went to the museum on Saturday. ____
- 3 Leif went there a couple of times on Saturday. ____
- 4 Miriam has never met Mirella. ____
- 5 Miriam has organized a desk for Mirella and it’s ready for her to use. ____
- 6 We don’t know when Leif played tennis. ____
- 7 Before the weekend, we don’t know when Leif last played tennis. ____

- 4 Match sentences a–d below to meanings 1–4.

- 1 Talking about a finished action that took place at a specified time: ____
- 2 Asking about an action / event – the speaker doesn’t say / know / ask when it took place: ____
- 3 Talking about a very recent action / event: ____
- 4 Asking about an action / event – the speaker asks / knows when the event took place: ____

- a I’ve just **organized** a desk for you to work from.
- b Did you **go** to the museum on Saturday?
- c Leif **played** tennis at the weekend.
- d Have you **met** Mirella?

- 5 Complete these sentences with *since* or *for*.

- 1 I haven’t played tennis _____ ages. = _____ + a period (days, months, years)
- 2 I haven’t seen you _____ January. = _____ + a specific time (day, date, year)

- 6 Work with a partner. Choose the correct answer from the words in *italics*.

- 1 I *booked* / *have booked* the hotel yesterday.
- 2 *Have you ever been* / *Did you ever go* to India?
- 3 I live in London now, but I *have lived* / *lived* in Paris from 2000 to 2002.
- 4 I *haven’t seen* / *didn’t see* him recently.
- 5 Last year I *have changed* / *changed* jobs.
- 6 *Did you go* / *have you been* to the meeting last week?
- 7 He has worked here *since* / *for* eight years.
- 8 She has been the CEO *since* / *for* December 2005.

» For more information and exercises, go to Practice file 3 on page 107.

- 7 Work with a partner. Ask and answer questions about the following. Start the questions with the word in *italics*.

- your present job / company (*How long have ...?*)
- date you joined (*When did you ...?*)
- previous job (*What was ...?*)
- education (*Where did you ...?*)
- travel (*Have you ever been ...?*)
- people (*Have you met ...?*)
- other subjects (*I still haven’t asked you about ...*)

Tip | Conversations

The present perfect is often used to start conversations. Speakers often use the past simple to continue the conversation and ask for / give more details.

A Have you **been** to Brazil?

B Yes I have.

A When **did** you **go**?

B I went two years ago.

❶ » Interactive Workbook » Exercises and Tests

Corridor conversations

Work in small groups. Each player places a counter on 'Start'. Take turns to roll a dice and move to another square.

Green squares – ask all the players a question using the phrase.

Blue squares – move to the nearest square another player is on and speak to that player.

Pink squares – a player talks to one other player.

Purple squares – follow the instructions.

The player who lands on 'End' first is the winner.

Start 1	Move to another player's square. Ask him / her about last night.	Have you met ...?	End 20
Do you like ...?	Move to another player's square. Say hello and ask a question.	Ask another player what he / she thinks of Mexican food.	Check the spelling of another player's name.
You make a useful contact. Have another go.	Move to another player's square. Ask him / her a question about his / her leisure time.	Where did you go when you last went abroad? Move to join a player who has also been there.	Work some unpaid overtime. Miss TWO goes.
Check another player's telephone number.	Take a day off. Miss a go.	(...) did you ...?	Ask another player what he / she thinks of football.
How do you find ...?	What sort of ...?	Check another player's email address.	Move to another player's square. Talk to him / her about last weekend then end the conversation politely.

Activity



4 Services & systems

Learning objectives in this unit

- Talking about services and systems
- Explaining how something works
- Introducing information
- Making comparisons

Case study

- Improving systems

Starting point

- 1 What services do you use regularly?
- 2 What do you like about them?
- 3 What makes services good or bad?

Working with words | Service

1 Read these website reviews.

- 1 Which of the extracts is about a website for
 - Lloyds TSB (a bank)?
 - The Guardian (a newspaper)?
 - Expedia.com (an online travel agency)?
- 2 Would you be interested in these services? Why / why not?

a

Instead of continuously visiting websites to see if there are new articles and updates, you can have them delivered directly to you. Its user-friendly service gives you access to all the most up-to-date and accurate news and information on the web.

b

This service is free and gives you immediate access to your accounts when it's convenient for you. The system also protects your personal financial information and ensures that you stay secure.

c

This system is really time-saving and efficient, because consumers can combine multiple flights, hotel bookings, car rentals, and local activities all from just one website. Users can customize their bookings to fit their needs and there are many discounts and special prices, so it's really cost-effective.



- 2 16▷ Listen to three speakers. Which website in 1 would they be interested in?

- 3 Underline the adjectives in the reviews in 1 that would attract the three speakers.

- 4 Work with a partner. Which of the adjectives you underlined in the texts in 1 might describe these services? Do you use services like these?



- 5 17▶ Listen to four people talking about a service from 4.
- 1 Which service is each person talking about?
 - 2 How does the service make their life easier or what does it allow them to do?

- 6 Work with a partner. Make sentences using the words in this table.

Example: Search engines allow people to find relevant websites.

Search engines	help	me	infinitive (with to ...)
Telecommunication companies	allow	you	
Financial advisers	make it easier for	organizations	
Call centres	let	companies	verb (without to ...)
Consultants		people	
Legal services		the world	

» For more exercises, go to Practice file 4 on page 108.

- 7 Make a list of the type of services your company offers or services you often use. They might be financial, travel, legal, or medical. Tell your partner about the benefits of these services.

Example: My financial adviser helps me to plan my future.

Booking tickets online is really efficient and more cost-effective than using a travel agent.

Tip | let

The verb *let* is followed by a noun and then a verb without *to*.

Don't say:

Online banking lets me to manage my account from home.

Do say:

Online banking lets me manage my account from home.

Presenting | Explaining how something works | Comparing new with old



- 1** Why do companies need databases? What sort of information do they keep? Do you use a database? If you do, is the system easy to use?
- 2** **18▷** A hotel chain has a new customer database for all its hotels. It is being presented to the hotel manager and her staff for the first time. Listen and answer questions 1–5.
 - 1 What was one of the disadvantages with the old database?
 - 2 When can they use the new database?
 - 3 How is it similar to the old database?
 - 4 What is new about it?
 - 5 What does the hotel manager suggest is a problem with the new system?
- 3** **18▷** Match 1–8 below to a–h to make pairs of phrases. Then listen again and check your answers.
 - 1 The good news is ..., _____
 - 2 It might seem a bit difficult to use at first ..., _____
 - 3 It looks very similar to ..., _____
 - 4 As soon as you ..., _____
 - 5 In other words, as well as (-ing) ..., _____
 - 6 The more ..., _____
 - 7 On the one hand ..., _____
 - 8 One downside is ..., _____
 - a but what's different is ...
 - b it also ...
 - c but the bad news is ...
 - d but on the other hand ...
 - e but in fact it's very simple.
 - f the (better) ...
 - g but on the plus side ...
 - h it starts to ...
- 4** Put the phrases in **3** into these categories.
 - a Comparing and contrasting: _____
 - b Describing what something does or how it works: _____

» For more exercises, go to **Practice file 4** on page 108.

- 5** Work with a partner. Imagine your company has some new software for storing customer information. Make sentences using some of the phrases from 3 and these prompts.

Example: The good news is we have new software, but the bad news is we need six months' training.

- 1 new software + need six months' training
- 2 press this button + look for the customer's name
- 3 the old system + the quantity of information it can store
- 4 storing basic information + finds more information
- 5 information you get + easier it is to target customers
- 6 the system is more complicated + it is faster

- 6** Work with a partner. Compare the functionality of the objects, systems, or services in 1–3. Make a list of the benefits and drawbacks of each of the more recent objects / systems.

Example: Compared to CD players, MP3 players store more songs, are smaller, and more expensive.

- 1 CD players MP3 players
- 2 filing cabinets folder storage systems on PCs
- 3 going into a bank using an online bank

- 7** Now work with a different partner. Take turns to talk about the functionality of 1–3.

Example: On the one hand, the MP3 player is expensive, but on the other hand, it can store thousands of songs.

- 8** Think of something that has recently changed at work. Tell your partner about the benefits and drawbacks of the change. It might be a change to

- working hours / breaks
- how supplies are ordered
- measuring customer satisfaction.

i » Interactive Workbook » Email

Key expressions

Explaining how something works

Let me explain how it works.

One / the main thing to note is ...

What happens is ...

Basically, ...

It's a bit like ...

You can see what happens when you ...

As soon as you ..., it starts to ...

Explaining additional features and benefits

One other useful feature is that ...

As well as (+ noun / -ing) ..., it also ...

The more ..., the better (the) ...

Asking questions about functionality

Will it let me ... (+ verb)?

Will it allow me ... (+ infinitive)?

How does it know what to do?

What happens when ...?

Comparing

On the one hand ..., but on the other hand ...

The good news is ..., but the bad news is ...

Whereas before ..., we now ...

It looks very similar to ..., but what's different is ...

It might seem ..., but in fact it's ...

One downside is ..., but on the plus side ...

One benefit is that ..., though a drawback might be ...

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» Phrasebank

Practically speaking | How to introduce information

- 1** 19▶ Listen to 1–5. Notice the stressed words in **bold** and the pauses (/) after the introductory phrases.

- 1 As you **know**, / we have a new customer database.
- 2 So the **purpose** of today / is for you to start to become familiar with it.
- 3 As I **say**, / the good news is ...
- 4 **Now**, / up on the screen you can see ...
- 5 In **other** words, / as well as giving the customer more of what they want ...

- 2** Match the sentences in 1 to functions a–e.

- a Repeating something you have already said: ____
- b Explaining a feature in a different way: ____
- c Giving information that is already common knowledge: ____
- d Explaining what is going to happen: ____
- e Introducing a new item: ____

- 3** Give a one-minute presentation to your partner about how an object in your classroom or office works. For example, the CD player or the answering machine. Try to use all five of the introductory phrases from 1 in your presentation.

Language at work | Comparative forms

1 A hotel manager has received these comments from staff on using the new customer database. Complete their comments with the correct form of the adjectives in brackets.

1 'It takes a little _____ (long) to learn how to use it.'

2 'When customers call, it's slightly _____ (easy) to find their information.'

3 'It's definitely not as _____ (slow) as the old system was.'

4 'Even the customers seem to be noticing the differences. They are far _____ (positive).'

5 'In general, I think it's a great deal _____ (good).'

2 Read the comments in **1** again. For each comment, decide if the improvement of the new database is big or small or if there is no improvement.

3 Correct the mistakes in this dialogue about a new office.

- 1 A This office is more noisier than the last one.
- 2 B Yeah, but at least it's not as darker as the old one.
- 3 A That's true. I just wish it was bigger.
- 4 B It's much convenienter for teamwork though.
- 5 A Yes, but it's much more worse for concentration.
- 6 B I think it's as good than the last office, but in different ways.
- 7 A Well, you've always been more tolerant that me.

4 Decide if these intensifiers indicate a big (B) or small (S) difference.

slightly _____ a great deal _____ nearly as ... as _____ not anything like as ... as _____
a little _____ significantly _____ far more _____ much less _____ marginally _____
not nearly ... as _____ a lot _____

» For more information and exercises, go to Practice file 4 on page 109.

5 Work with a partner. Your local supermarket has changed its layout and updated its website. Take turns to ask and answer questions from this customer feedback form using the adjectives in brackets. Circle 0, 1, 2, or 3 to show your partner's opinion.

Example: A What do you think of the choice of goods?

*B The choice is slightly **wider** than before. (Student A circles ② on the form.)*

Feedback form

Level of improvement (0 = got worse, 1 = none, 2 = some, 3 = big):

What do you think of the choice of goods? (wide)	0	1	2	3
How easy is it to find items? (easy)	0	1	2	3
What do you think of the wait at the checkout? (long / short)	0	1	2	3
What do you think of the café and children's area? (good / bad)	0	1	2	3
What do you think of the website? (user-friendly)	0	1	2	3

6 Work with a partner. Compare your present job with your last job. Choose your own adjectives or use some from the list to talk about the areas below.

*friendly long stressful challenging helpful modern
convenient fast comfortable difficult interesting*

- your colleagues
- your office / work place
- your responsibilities
- your working hours
- your journey to work

» Interactive Workbook » Exercises and Tests

Improving systems

Background

Travelling responsibly at Nike HQ

When Nike World Headquarters relocated to a suburb outside Portland, Oregon in the USA, the management decided to save money by building fewer car parking spaces at the new site. At this time, 98% of Nike's employees drove alone to work, and there were too many cars for the number of parking spaces.

Management soon realized they needed to encourage fewer people to drive to work alone. They started an incentive-based programme – employees who shared car journeys, cycled to work or used public transport received money towards their

travel costs, or vouchers that they could spend in the cafeterias at work and at Nike stores. It was a popular programme, but it was expensive and difficult to monitor. They then introduced a new system called TRAC – Travelling Responsibly? Accept the Challenge. TRAC gave employees information about public transport, cycling routes, and car-sharing and offered monthly prizes to employees. The company also started to pay 72% of the cost of bus and rail passes.

The percentage of employees driving alone to work is now 78%. However, the company would like to reduce this figure still further.

Discussion

- 1 What are the advantages of not driving to work for
1 the employees? 2 the company? 3 the local community?
- 2 What could the company do to reduce the number of employees driving alone to work even further?
- 3 What alternative means of transport would you consider using to get to work? Give your reasons.

Task

- 1 Work with a partner. You both work for a large manufacturing company. The commuting situation at your company needs to improve. Read this information.
 - Your company employs 30% more people than it did two years ago. As a result there are too few parking spaces and it is unable to get more space for employees' cars.
 - Traffic in the area is getting worse and employees travelling by car are often stuck in traffic jams and arrive at work late, feeling very stressed.
- 2 Hold a meeting with your partner. Take turns to report some recent relevant data. Make notes as you listen. Student A, turn to File 05 on page 136. Student B, turn to File 12 on page 138.
- 3 Make a list of ways to improve the situation. Will you need to change the system of parking? Can you change the working hours? Perhaps you can encourage alternative means of transport for employees.
- 4 Present your ideas to the class. Explain how the new system will work and explain its benefits compared to the current situation. Your audience may want to ask you questions about how it will work.

The Expert View

Why change?

If staff are dissatisfied (D) with the current situation, and if there's a vision (V) for improvement and a clear process (P), then the cost of not changing (C) is more than the cost of changing ($D \times V \times P > C$). Change is resisted if dissatisfaction, vision and / or process don't exist.

What 'change process'?

Try a typical four-stage process: 1 awareness of the need for change, 2 interest in the process, 3 willingness to try the changes, 4 acceptance. Different stages need different tactics, but the 'platinum rule' is – do for other people what they would do for themselves!

Cora Lynn Heimer-Rathbone,
Programme Director, Centre for
Customized Executive Development
Cranfield School of Management



Case study



5 Customers

Learning objectives in this unit

- Talking about customer service
- Getting information
- Making and changing arrangements
- Starting a conversation on the phone
- Using the present simple and continuous to talk about the future
- Managing customer feedback

Case study

- Managing customer feedback

Starting point

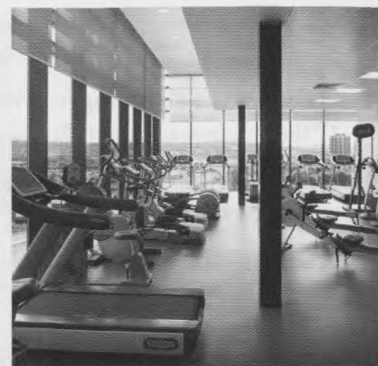
- 1 Who does your company sell products or provide services to?
- 2 Which departments and employees in your company need your services or products to do their job?
- 3 Your answers to 1 are your *external customers*. Your answers to 2 are your *internal customers*. Compare your answers to 1 and 2 with a partner's answers.

Working with words | Customer service

- 1 Read this information. What does Technogym do? Who are its customers?

Technogym

Nerio Alessandri built his first fitness machine in his garage in 1983 and founded Technogym. The company is now a market leader in fitness and biomedical rehabilitation equipment. Its products have been chosen by over 30,000 fitness centres and 20,000 private homes worldwide. It was the official supplier at the Sydney 2000 and Athens 2004 Olympics and Paralympics, and at the Turin 2006 Winter Olympics.



- 2 Complete these sections of a website homepage with words from the list.

requirements care satisfaction services expectations

We're here to help

Whatever you require, our call centres are open to assist you with all issues concerning our products and ¹_____.

The design team

Our in-house design team assesses the proposed area of development to give the best layout of equipment. It then monitors every stage of the installation for complete ²_____.

After-sales

The After-Sales Service extranet site provides online ³_____ and support 24/7.

Technical support

Our technical support team ensures that the equipment is always in perfect working order and matches your ⁴_____.

Tailor-made courses

We tailor our courses to meet the specific ⁵_____ of our clients, with in-house training courses.

3 Which sections of the website in 2 should these customers click on?

1 'I want to download a copy of the instructions for your treadmill.'

3 'Would it be possible to get some more information about your products?'

2 'We're interested in having a small gym for employees in our office building but I don't think there's space for it.'

4 'I'd like all of my staff to understand how the machines work.'

5 'I can't seem to change the speed of the treadmill.'

4 Complete this table with words from 1 and 2.

Noun	Verb	Adjective
1 _____	serve	—
2 _____	satisfy	satisfied
3 _____	supply	supplied
4 _____	care	caring
5 _____	expect	expected
6 _____	require	required
7 _____	produce	—

5 Complete this text with the correct form of words from the table in 4.

Customers always ¹ _____ a company to ² _____ them with top-quality goods and ³ _____. They are ⁴ _____ if their ⁵ _____ are met. If their ⁶ _____ are not met, however, it is the role of the customer ⁷ _____ department to try to sort out any problems. If the customer receives efficient and helpful ⁸ _____ and feels that the company really ⁹ _____ about them, this will result in a happy customer who is more likely to buy the company's ¹⁰ _____ and services again.

6 Complete these questions with the correct form of words from the website sections in 2 to match the words in brackets.

- What kind of customers do you *assist*? (help) What do they usually _____? (need)
- How do you _____ their needs? (evaluate)
- Is there a department at your company which continually _____ customer service? (checks)
- What do you think is one way to _____ customer satisfaction? (guarantee)
- Are you able to _____ 24-hour-a-day support to your customers? (give)
- Is it important to be able to _____ your products or services? (adapt)

» For more exercises, go to Practice file 5 on page 110.

7 Work with a partner. Ask and answer the questions in 6 using the words you found in the website sections in 2.

8 Think of a service you know well. It could be your own company's product or service, or one you have recently bought or used. Present this product or service to the class, as if you are trying to promote it to them. Explain what makes it so good.

Tip | *customer, client, and consumer*

A *customer* is someone who buys a standard product or service.

A *client* is someone who buys an individually designed product or service, for example, financial advice.

Consumer is a general term to talk about any person who buys things, not a specific product or service.

Exchanging information | Getting information | Making and changing arrangements



2.15 p.m.

1 _____ ?

A chain of 4- and 5-star
hotels in Switzerland.

2 _____ ?

Ten years old.

3 _____ ?

Eleven in total.

4 _____ ?

Not known.

1 20▷ Listen to this phone call between Elena Schenker, the facilities manager of a hotel chain, and Sergio Lanese, a Technogym representative. Complete Sergio's notes. What information does he ask for?

2 20▷ Listen again and complete these phrases for getting information.

- 1 I'd like to _____ your services ...
- 2 Can you _____ a little more?
- 3 We're _____ updating ...
- 4 Is that something you _____?
- 5 Would it be _____ someone to ...?

3 Work with a partner. Student A, you are a hotel facilities manager. Turn to File 06 on page 136. Student B, you are a sales representative for Technogym. Answer your partner's phone call and ask for the same information as in the notes in **1**. Then change roles. Student B, turn to File 14 on page 138. Student A, use the notes in **1**.

4 21▷ Listen to the end of Sergio and Elena's phone conversation and answer questions 1–3.

- 1 What do they arrange?
- 2 What is planned for the 30th?
- 3 What is planned for the 1st?

5 21▷ Listen again and complete these sentences.

- 1 Can we _____ a meeting then?
- 2 _____ about Tuesday the 31st?
- 3 I _____ the Wednesday.
- 4 The 1st of February? Yes, that _____ me.

6 Work with a partner. Take turns to answer the phone and make arrangements for the situations below. Use this flow chart and your own diaries if you want.

A Answer the phone.

B Suggest an arrangement.

A Agree and suggest two possible dates / times.

B State your preferred date / time.

A Agree and say goodbye.

- meeting to plan new website
- celebrating your birthday
- playing golf or tennis
- visiting your new company headquarters
- an anniversary dinner

Tip | make

Make has many uses. Here it means to attend.

*I can't **make** the meeting. = I can't attend the meeting.*

7 22▷ Sergio calls Elena again. Listen and answer questions 1–4.

- 1 What is the main reason for his call?
- 2 What else do they talk about?
- 3 What can't Sergio make?
- 4 What do Sergio and Elena move back?

» For more exercises, go to Practice file 5 on page 110.

8 Read this sentence and then change the diary page below.

6 Fabio can't make the 27th, so we'll bring the meeting forward a day and move the tour back a day. 9

26	27 Meeting at 9.30 a.m. Tour at 3.00 p.m.	28	29
----	---	----	----

9 Repeat your calls in 6 but now you can't make the appointments. Change the arrangements to a new time. Use this flow chart and your own diaries if you want.

A Answer the phone.

B Give your reason for calling. Apologize and explain. Suggest alternative dates / times.

A State your preferred date / time.

B Agree and say goodbye.

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Key expressions

Stating interest

I'd like to find out about ...
We're interested in ...

Asking for information

Can you tell me a little more ...?
Is that something you deal with?
Would it be possible for ...?

Suggesting arrangements

Can we fix / arrange a date for the meeting?
What / How about the 30th of January?

Stating a preference

I'd prefer the Tuesday.
Tuesday would be better.
The 31st is good for me
Thursday suits me.

Changing arrangements

Sorry, I can't make the Thursday.
I'm afraid I can't come on / make Thursday.
Can we move it back to Friday?
Can we bring it forward to Wednesday?
The afternoon is free / convenient.

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Practically speaking | Starting a conversation on the phone

1 23▷ The first time we speak to someone on the phone we are usually quite formal. After that the calls may be more conversational. Match phrases 1–5 to responses a–e. Then listen to five conversations and check your answers.

- 1 Sorry for calling so late. _____
- 2 How are things? _____
- 3 Is this a busy time for you? _____
- 4 What's the weather like? _____
- 5 Hello, Anna. This is James. _____

- a No, I'm not too busy at the moment.
- b It's really beautiful and clear.
- c Everything's going fine, thanks.
- d Hello. How are you?
- e Don't worry – I don't usually finish before 7.00.

2 Work with a partner. Start a phone call. Use phrases from 1 or your own conversational openers.

Language at work | Present simple and continuous for future use

1 24▷ Listen to these sentences. Choose the correct answer from the verbs in *italics*.

- 1 We *come* / *'re coming* to Switzerland next month.
- 2 Customers often *comment* / *are commenting* on this.
- 3 I *call* / *'m calling* for some information.
- 4 My trip *begins* / *is beginning* on the 30th of January.

2 Which sentences in **1** are about the future?

3 Which of the sentences you selected in **2** describes

- a an arrangement? ____ b a schedule / timetable? ____

4 Complete these sentences with *simple* or *continuous*.

- 1 Use the present _____ to talk about an arrangement for the future.
- 2 Use the present _____ to talk about a scheduled or timetabled event in the future.

» For more information and exercises, go to **Practice file 5** on page 111.

5 Complete this email with the present simple or present continuous form of the verbs in brackets.

✉

Dear Elena

I ¹_____ (write) to confirm that we ²_____ (meet) on Thursday at 2.00 p.m. My train ³_____ (arrive) at 12.30, so there shouldn't be any problems. One of our technicians ⁴_____ (come) with me. He's called Mario.

We look forward to seeing you.

Sergio

6 Work with a partner. Look at the diary and make sentences in the present simple or present continuous using prompts 1–9.

Example: I'm going to a conference next week.

The conference starts on Tuesday.

- | | | |
|-----------------------|-------------------------|-------------------------|
| 1 go / conference | 4 conference / start | 7 first session / start |
| 2 have / team meeting | 5 fly / Paris | 8 flight / leave |
| 3 have / lunch | 6 speak / at conference | 9 presentation / start |

May

	a.m.	p.m.
6 Monday	10.00 Team meeting	
7 Tuesday	____ CONFERENCE ____ 9.30 First session	
8 Wednesday	____ CONFERENCE ____	14.00 My presentation
9 Thursday	____ CONFERENCE ____	12.30 Lunch with Sally and Remi
10 Friday	To Paris.	14.20 Flight from LHR.

Tip | Action and state verbs

Remember that some verbs (state verbs) are not used in the present continuous when they are talking about states, not actions. For example: *understand, like, know, believe, mean, need*.

Managing customer feedback

Background

Limewood Spa is an exclusive country house hotel and spa. It has a very good reputation, but recently it has received negative customer feedback on several websites.



Set in its own country garden, Limewood Spa believes in combining state-of-the-art facilities with natural therapies. Limewood Spa is unique in being able to offer long, quiet walks in its fifty-acre forest followed by vigorous exercise in the fitness centre. We assess your fitness on your first morning and tailor your programme. Our five-star restaurant is run by chefs specializing in healthy cooking.

Customer feedback

'This hotel is set in a most beautiful location. The problem was the restaurant. The service was poor and the food itself was expensive and not very good. When we mentioned this to the manager, she said that we were the only people complaining so things couldn't be that bad!'

'The room was very nice, and the setting is wonderful. It's a shame the staff aren't more helpful.'

'The hotel was very clean and you could see that the rooms had been refurbished recently. The health spa in the basement was of a really high standard. The main problem was that the staff didn't seem interested, and only really attended to our needs when we asked them.'

'We arrived in the restaurant at 9.34 (to be exact), only to be told that the kitchen closed at 9.30 and we were too late for dinner!'

Discussion

- 1 Based on the information in their brochure, what would you expect as a customer at Limewood Spa? Do you think they are living up to their good reputation? Why / why not?
- 2 Is it important to act on customer feedback? How much do customers' comments affect business?
- 3 How should Limewood Spa respond to the negative customer feedback?

Task

- 1 Limewood Spa needs to do something about the bad feedback it has received from some customers. The hotel manager has decided to contact a firm of business consultants for advice. Work with a partner. Student A, turn to File 07 on page 137. Student B, turn to File 13 on page 138. Read the information and follow the instructions.
- 2 You are now at the arranged meeting. Brainstorm some ideas for how the hotel can offer better customer service and guarantee customer satisfaction. Discuss your ideas and what you are going to do.
- 3 Present your ideas to the rest of the class.

The Expert View

In any business, it is a mistake to invest in facilities for customers without training staff in customer care. Success means building good relationships with customers, and good service means loyal customers. Poor customer service and poor maintenance of customer relations can mean long-term damage to an organization's reputation and, eventually, loss of profitability. Solutions include better staff training and rewards for good customer care, a commitment to maintaining good customer relations, and an effective system for responding to complaints and feedback.

Lynette Ryals, Professor of Strategic Sales and Account Management
Cranfield School of Management

Case study



6 | Guests & visitors

Learning objectives in this unit

- Talking about business travel
- Welcoming visitors to your place of work
- Making and responding to offers
- Using modal verbs to talk about work regulations

Case study

- Solving an intercultural problem

Starting point

- 1 How often do you have business guests or visitors?
- 2 Why do they come to see you?
- 3 How do you entertain them (if at all)?
- 4 How often do you travel for work?
- 5 What do you think of the hospitality you receive when you travel for work?
- 6 How much free time do you have for sightseeing or enjoying yourself?
- 7 Do you prefer being the visitor or the host? Why?

Working with words | Business travel

1 Read this information from a recent survey of business travellers and answer questions 1–2.

- 1 Are most business travellers positive or negative about business travel?
- 2 How close are the views of the travellers in the survey to your own views?

Travelling for business – love it or hate it?

Most business travellers (87%) believe that technology such as email and 'virtual' meetings cannot replace face-to-face contact.

Over three-quarters of business travellers enjoy travelling for business (78%). Of these, 66% like the variety, 62% appreciate the opportunity to see the world, and 51% enjoy experiencing a new culture. But only 8% say it makes them feel important.

Of those who don't enjoy travelling for business – 58% find it tiring and stressful, 55% say it affects their personal life, 46% don't like being away from home, and 32% just find it boring. Almost a third of business travellers (30%) have experienced a cancellation, a missed flight, or a delay.



- 2 25, 26▷ Seville is an important destination for business travellers. It hosts many conferences and exhibitions. The local chamber of commerce is doing a survey at the airport to find out why business travellers come to Seville. Listen to two interviews and complete this table.

	Traveller 1	Traveller 2
Reason for visit		
Where they are staying		
Plans (professional / personal)		



3 25▷ Listen again. Match the words from the list to definitions 1–10.

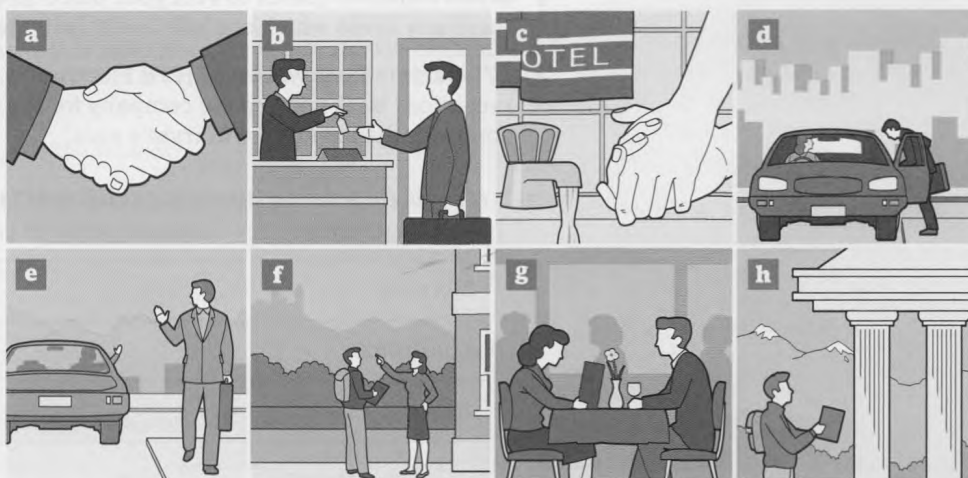
conference entertainment exhibition excursion venue
facilities hospitality nightlife sightseeing speciality

- 1 visiting interesting buildings and places as a tourist: _____
- 2 a large meeting where people with the same work or interests come together: _____
- 3 the place where a conference or a big event is held: _____
- 4 space, equipment, and services provided (e.g. by a hotel): _____
- 5 friendly and welcoming behaviour to guests: _____
- 6 a type of food or product that a restaurant or place is famous for: _____
- 7 things to do in the evening (e.g. bars, restaurants, etc.): _____
- 8 somewhere you go to see different products or works of art: _____
- 9 a short, organized trip made for interest or pleasure: _____
- 10 activities which people do for fun and relaxation: _____

4 Work with a partner. Cover up your answers in 3 and take turns to test each other with the definitions.

5 26▷ Listen again. Match a word from A to a word or phrase from B to make a new phrase. Then match each new phrase to pictures a–h.

A	B
freshen	out
pick	around
look	(someone) off
check	up
meet	(someone) up
show	in
drop	up with
eat	(someone) around



» For more exercises, go to Practice file 6 on page 112.

6 Work with a partner. Two visitors are coming to speak at a conference in your nearest city. You have to look after both of them. Use the information below to create a plan for their visit. Decide what will happen (and when) from the time you pick them up from the airport. Use words and phrases from 3 and 5.

	Visitor A	Visitor B
Arrival	Friday 16.30	Friday 10.30
Time of presentation	Saturday 9.30–11.00	Saturday 11.30–13.00
Departure	Saturday 16.30	Saturday 15.00
Preferences / requests	- wants to see conference venue and facilities on Friday - wants an early night on Friday - likes traditional food - wants to see the city	- needs one hour on Saturday to prepare / set up presentation - likes lively evening entertainment - wants to see the city - wants to go shopping

Tip | travel, trip, and journey

Travel is mainly used as a verb.

I like to **travel** by train.

There are some exceptions:

business travel, travel arrangements, and travel agents.

Don't say:

~~Did you have a good travel?~~

Do say:

Did you have a good **journey** / **trip** / **flight**?

Journey is the period spent travelling to your destination.

Trip is a short visit with a specific purpose (e.g. a business trip).

Socializing | Welcoming visitors



- 1 When someone comes to visit your place of work, what do you show them? Are there any areas which are 'off-limits' (private or secret)?
- 2 27▷ Jacinta Ross works for HYB Electronics. She meets Marvin Bernstein at reception. He is visiting the company for the day. Listen to their conversation and complete the agenda for Marvin's visit.

Agenda for Marvin Bernstein's visit to HYB Electronics
Monday 2 October

Morning:

Lunchtime:

Afternoon:

- 3 27▷ Listen again and complete these phrases that Jacinta uses.

- 1 _____ our new facility.
- 2 It's nice to _____ in person.
- 3 So, how was _____?
- 4 And did you have _____ finding us?
- 5 Here, _____ your coat.
- 6 Can I _____ a coffee?
- 7 OK. Come this way and I'll _____ today's programme.
- 8 So, first of all, I _____ join a tour of the facility this morning.
- 9 Then, _____ at lunchtime.
- 10 He's introducing the tour this morning, but _____ to meet up with him over lunch.
- 11 You'll need this ID card to get around the site. _____ you keep it on you at all times.
- 12 Yes, _____ that. I'll clear it with Facilities.

- 4 Work with a partner. Match these responses to phrases 1–8 in 3.

- | | |
|----------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| a Likewise. _____ | e Yes, please. Black, no sugar. _____ |
| b Thank you. _____ | f I'll hang onto it, thanks. _____ |
| c OK. _____ | g Not really, it was easy. _____ |
| d That sounds interesting. _____ | h It was fine, thanks. _____ |